Apple Inc.

AAPL NASDAQ

Hold	$357.60 ▲ 0.77%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$375.00	$243.42 – $360.83	$5.20T

AAPL: Quietly Grinding to New Highs as Nvidia Wobbles

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL popped to a fresh 52-week high ($357.60, now at 97% of its yearly range) while Nvidia got absolutely hammered — losing $650B in market cap after Jensen Huang's shock resignation. This is a classic "flight to quality" trade: when the AI darling stumbles, money runs to the mega-cap that's seen as boring and reliable. Apple is now the anti-Nvidia.
- The new Siri-powered HomeView and refreshed Apple TV hit shelves today — small headline, but it's the first real product proof that Apple's long-delayed AI strategy is actually shipping. Market liked it (+1%).

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really happening: AAPL is benefiting from a defensive rotation, not from its own fundamentals suddenly improving. When Nvidia's story cracked today, portfolio managers who need "tech exposure" without the drama parked money in Apple — that's why you see Apple green while the Nasdaq is red. The options flow is telling a more cautious story though — put volume is slightly elevated (put/call of 1.03) and there's massive unusual put activity at the $357.50 strike, meaning big players are paying up for downside protection right at today's price. Combined with the general counsel selling stock four weeks in a row like clockwork, the message is: enjoy the rally, but someone with better information is quietly trimming.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch is the China tariff framework — the administration has been renegotiating Section 301 tariffs, and Apple still assembles the majority of iPhones in China. Any escalation is a direct hit to gross margins (roughly 150-200 basis points per 10% tariff bump, by most analyst math). Separately, the EU's Digital Markets Act enforcement is intensifying — Apple just lost another App Store appeal in Brussels, and the fact that their SVP of Government Affairs (Newstead) is systematically selling stock while running point on these regulatory battles is… noteworthy. Antitrust pressure is the quiet headwind nobody's pricing in.

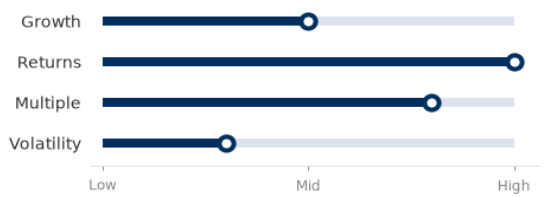
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At $357, you're paying about 45x forward earnings — meaning $45 for every $1 of profit Apple makes next year. That's richer than Microsoft (~32x) and Google (~25x), and historically Apple trades at 28-32x. The premium is justifiable IF services revenue keeps compounding at 12%+ and the AI product cycle drives an iPhone upgrade wave — but at 97% of the 52-week range, you're buying perfection.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data	
Price (USD)	**$357.60**
12M Price Target	**$375.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+4.9%**
Market Cap	**$5.20T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$455M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$490M**
FY2026E EPS	**$7.85**
FY2027E EPS	**$8.75**
Fwd P/E	**45.6x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

AAPL — Apple Inc. | November 13, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$375.00**	$360.00	**$335.00**
6 Months	**$400.00**	$370.00	**$310.00**
1 Year	**$430.00**	$375.00	**$290.00**
2 Years	**$500.00**	$410.00	**$270.00**
5 Years	**$700.00**	$525.00	**$300.00**
10 Years	**$1100.00**	$750.00	**$350.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+1.11%) and Communication Services (+0.94%) — classic defensive rotation signal. When staples and comms lead, big money is getting cautious on growth.

COOLING OFF: Semiconductors and AI hardware — Nvidia down big, Applied Materials sinking, Dell under pressure. The AI capex trade is being questioned for the first time in 18 months.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly leaving high-beta AI infrastructure and flowing into mega-cap quality (Apple, staples, healthcare). This is "I still want to own stocks but I'm nervous" positioning.

RELATED PLAY: If the Nvidia wobble sticks, Microsoft and Google benefit as the "sensible AI exposure" trade — they also have the balance sheets to survive any AI capex slowdown.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Benefiting from the same defensive AI rotation — enterprise software seen as recession-resistant.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Cheapest mega-cap AI play, Gemini traction finally showing up in cloud numbers.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is leading its mega-cap peers today, but that's largely because it's seen as the safest harbor, not because its business is suddenly accelerating. When AAPL leads on a "fear day," it usually means the next 2-3 weeks are choppy — the rally is defensive, not offensive.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Great company, extended price. I'm not selling, but I'm not chasing here either.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% as a core holding. Apple is the kind of name you own through cycles, not trade around headlines.

ENTRY POINTS: Wait for a pullback to $335-345 — any broader tech selloff gets you a better entry. Don't chase the 52-week high with the options market flashing yellow.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is the December quarter earnings (late January) — that tells us if the AI-powered product cycle is actually driving upgrades.

WHEN TO BAIL: China tariff escalation above 25%, services growth drops below 8%, or if the insider selling turns into cluster selling by multiple executives (right now it's just one).

HEDGING: Buy a put option at the $340 strike expiring in January — think of it as insurance that pays off if the stock falls below $340. Costs a few dollars, saves you 10%+ in a bad scenario.

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